

My Rooted Journal

Six weeks of getting to know the person God made

Sofia

Rooted in Real Life | Teen Program

"I praise you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made."

Psalm 139:14

WELCOME

How to use this journal

This journal is just for you. You'll spend about 5 minutes a day and a little longer once a week. There are no grades and no wrong answers. Be honest, and be kind to yourself while you do it.

EACH WEEK HAS

- **The big idea** - a short lesson, plus a Scripture to carry with you.
- **A worksheet** - something to think through or try.
- **A daily check-in** - a few quick lines each day.
- **Reflect and prepare** - a longer reflection, and notes for your 1:1 with Cassandra.

THE SIX WEEKS

1	**Meeting Yourself**	What your assessments are and what they mean
2	**The R.O.O.T.E.D. Model**	A path through any hard or confusing moment
3	**The Stress Response**	What happens when you're stressed, and the Bridge Thought
4	**Virtue and Predominant Fault**	Where you need God's help most, and how you grow
5	**Charisms and Your Mission**	Your gifts, and what they are for
6	**Rooted in Today's World**	Living this out with your phone, school, and friends

If something here feels heavy. This journal is for reflection. It isn't a test or a diagnosis. If something brings up big or painful feelings, please talk to a parent, a youth leader, a counselor, or a priest. In the U.S. you can call or text **988** any time. If you are in danger, call **911**.

YOUR STARTING POINT

My Soul Snapshot

From the Soul Portrait you completed

These are starting points, not labels. You get to decide what feels true. You'll look at each of them more closely in the weeks ahead.

TEMPERAMENT

Choleric (main), Sanguine (second)

How God wired your soul. You're a natural leader: driven, decisive, and ready to take charge. Your second temperament adds warmth, energy, and fun with people.

PREDOMINANT FAULT

Pride

The pattern that most often trips you up. Pride isn't confidence. It's needing to be right or in charge, and it can make correction hard to hear. Anger and Resentment also scored high, so you'll keep an eye on that one too.

CHARISMS

Wisdom, Mercy, Teaching

Gifts the Holy Spirit gave you for other people: seeing what's really going on, caring for people who are hurting, and helping others understand. Prophecy and Hospitality scored the same as Teaching, so notice if either of those feels like you too.

SABOTEUR

The Controller (main)

A thought pattern that undermines your peace. The Avoider showed up strongly too, and the Hyper-Achiever and the Wounded One showed up some.

"Before I formed you in the womb I knew you."
Jeremiah 1:5

WEEK 1 OF 6

Meeting Yourself

THE BIG IDEA

You took four short assessments. Think of them as four mirrors that show a different part of you:

Temperament is how God wired you to respond to the world. **Predominant fault** is the one pattern that most often trips you up, and it's where God's grace is aimed at you. **Charism** is a gift of the Holy Spirit that is meant for other people. A **saboteur** is a thought pattern that undermines your peace and your mission.

None of these are labels. Nobody is only one thing. Saints had every temperament, and every one of them had faults too. The goal is not to fix you. The goal is to know you, so you can grow into who God made you to be.

SCRIPTURE

"I praise you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made."

— Psalm 139:14

THIS WEEK I WILL

- Read my Soul Snapshot once each day.
- Notice one time this week when a result shows up in real life.
- Be kind to myself every time I notice something.

→ **In my own words, the big idea this week is...**

WEEK 1

Looking in the Mirror

→ **Which result felt the most like me, and why?**

→ **Which result surprised me?**

→ **Is there a result I wanted to push back on? What would I say to it?**

Things I love about how God made me

WEEK 1

Daily Check-In

A few minutes a day. Short answers are perfect.

Each day, jot down one small moment when you noticed something about yourself.

Day	Today I felt...	A moment I noticed (and which result it connects to)	Something kind I told myself
Mon			[ ]
Tue			[ ]
Wed			[ ]
Thu			[ ]
Fri			[ ]
Sat			[ ]
Sun			[ ]

WEEK 1

Reflect and Prepare

WEEKLY REFLECTION

→ **What do I hope to learn about myself in these six weeks?**

→ **What is one thing I'm already good at that I don't give myself credit for?**

FOR MY 1:1 WITH CASSANDRA

One thing I want to talk about:

One thing I'm proud of this week:

One question I have about my results:

WEEK 2 OF 6

The R.O.O.T.E.D. Model

THE BIG IDEA

Life gets confusing. Friends say something that stings, school piles up, and you can't tell why you reacted the way you did. The R.O.O.T.E.D. Model is a path you can walk through any moment like that. It has six steps, one for each letter.

R - Reality. What is actually happening? Say it plainly, before you try to fix it or judge it.
O - Origin. Where is this coming from? Name the pattern or old story behind it.
O - Overflow. What am I feeling, and where do I feel it in my body?
T - Turning. Turn toward God before you act. One sentence is enough.
E - Election. Choose the one next right thing, on purpose, not by reaction.
D - Dwelling. Settle in. Stay with God and with the choice you made, and let it shape how you live.

You don't have to do it perfectly. Most of the time you'll only get partway, and that is a good start.

SCRIPTURE

"He is like a tree planted by water, that sends out its roots by the stream."
— Jeremiah 17:8

THIS WEEK I WILL

- Notice one moment a day that I could walk through the six steps.
- Practice the first step (Reality) out loud: say what's happening in one plain sentence.
- Try all six steps once, on paper.

→ **In my own words, the big idea this week is...**

WEEK 2

Walk Through One Real Moment

Pick one real moment from this week, big or small. Write it here: _____

R — **Reality**
What actually happened? Just the facts.

O — **Origin**
What pattern or old story is behind this?

O — **Overflow**
What did I feel? Where did I feel it in my body?

T — **Turning**
What one sentence could I say to God?

E — **Election**
What is the one next right thing?

D — **Dwelling**
How can I stay with that choice and with God?

WEEK 2

Daily Check-In

A few minutes a day. Short answers are perfect.

Each day, catch one moment and see how far through the six steps you got.

Day	A moment I noticed	Steps I got to (circle) R O O T E D	Notes
Mon			
Tue			
Wed			
Thu			
Fri			
Sat			
Sun			

WEEK 2

Reflect and Prepare

WEEKLY REFLECTION

→ **Which step is easiest for me? Which is hardest?**

→ **When I slow down and look at what's really happening, what do I notice?**

→ **Where in my life could I use this path the most?**

FOR MY 1:1 WITH CASSANDRA

One thing I want to talk about:

One moment I walked through:

A step I'm stuck on:

WEEK 3 OF 6

The Stress Response

THE BIG IDEA

When something stressful happens, your body reacts before your thinking brain catches up. Your heart pounds, you say something sharp, you shut down, or you try to please everyone. That is not a sin. Feelings are information. The Church teaches that our emotions are not good or bad in themselves. What matters is what we choose to do with them.

This week you'll learn two tools. The **Hard-Moment Protocol** is for the moment of stress: **Name it. Pray. Elect.** (Elect means choose the next right thing.) The **Bridge Thought** is for the thoughts that keep playing afterward.

A Bridge Thought is when you notice an unkind thought, like *"I'm not good at school,"* and you cross the bridge to a kinder one: *"I'm still learning, and this is still new to me."* You are not lying to yourself. You are choosing a thought that is kinder and still honest.

SCRIPTURE

"For God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power and love and self-control."

— 2 Timothy 1:7

THIS WEEK I WILL

- Name what I feel when I'm stressed, using the feelings list.
- Use Name It, Pray, Elect at least once.
- Catch at least three unkind thoughts and cross the bridge on each one.

→ **In my own words, the big idea this week is...**

WEEK 3

Know Your Stress Response

When you're stressed, your body picks a response automatically. Which one is the most like you? Circle it.

Fight	You push back, take control, argue to win.	The Judge, The Controller
Flight	You escape, get busy, or distract yourself.	The Hyper-Achiever, The Avoider
Freeze	You shut down and go numb.	The Avoider, The Wounded One
Fawn	You please people and make yourself small.	The Pleaser, The Avoider

Your Controller usually shows up as Fight. Your Avoider can show up as Flight (staying busy or distracted), Freeze, or Fawn. Notice which one is yours.

NAME THE FEELING

Find the family first, then the most exact word. Circle what fits.

Joy	Excited - Content - Peaceful - Grateful - Hopeful
Fear	Anxious - Insecure - Ashamed - Worried - Nervous
Sadness	Lonely - Grieving - Hurt - Abandoned - Hopeless
Anger	Frustrated - Irritated - Overwhelmed - Resentful - Bitter
Disgust	Bored - Apathetic - Indifferent - Envious

→ **The feeling I'm naming this week:**

→ **Where I feel it in my body:**

→ **What set it off:**

WEEK 3

Two Tools

THE HARD-MOMENT PROTOCOL

1	**Name It** Say what is happening inside you, out loud if you can. "This is the Controller." "I'm anxious right now."
2	**Pray** One sentence, before you act. "Jesus, I trust in You." "Holy Spirit, I need You."
3	**Elect** Choose the one next right thing you'll be at peace with tomorrow. Not perfect. Just chosen.

THE BRIDGE THOUGHT

Unkind thought
"I'm not good at school."

-- bridge -->

Kinder thought
"I'm still learning, and this is still new to me."

Try it. Write three unkind thoughts you've had lately and cross the bridge on each one. Ideas for your own patterns are below.

Unkind thought	Kinder thought (still honest)
Example (Controller): "If I don't do it all, everything will fall apart."	*"I can do my part and trust God with the rest."*
Example (Avoider): "If I ignore it, it'll go away."	*"I can face this one small step at a time."*
Example (Pride): "I have to be right."	*"I can be wrong and still be okay."*

WEEK 3

Daily Check-In

A few minutes a day. Short answers are perfect.

Each day, name one feeling and catch one unkind thought. Then check the box if you used Name It, Pray, Elect.

Day	Feeling + where I felt it	Unkind thought -> kinder thought	Used the protocol
Mon			[ ]
Tue			[ ]
Wed			[ ]
Thu			[ ]
Fri			[ ]
Sat			[ ]
Sun			[ ]

WEEK 3

Reflect and Prepare

WEEKLY REFLECTION

→ **What does my body do when I'm stressed? Which of Fight, Flight, Freeze, or Fawn is mine?**

→ **What was my favorite Bridge Thought this week? How did it feel to cross?**

→ **What happened when I named a feeling instead of pushing it away?**

FOR MY 1:1 WITH CASSANDRA

One thing I want to talk about:

A hard moment I used the protocol in:

A thought I couldn't cross yet:

WEEK 4 OF 6

Virtue and Predominant Fault

THE BIG IDEA

A **virtue** is a good habit that gets stronger the more you practice it, like a muscle. Every fault has an opposite virtue, and growing means practicing the virtue, not just fighting the fault.

Your assessment showed that your predominant fault is **Pride**. That does not mean confidence is bad, and it does not mean you're a bad person. Pride is needing to be right, needing to be in charge, or having a hard time hearing correction. It can sneak in on people who are good at things, and as a natural leader, that includes you. Having a predominant fault is not a failure. It's exactly where God's grace is aimed at you.

The opposite virtue is **humility**. Humility isn't thinking you're bad at things. It's seeing yourself truthfully: you have real strengths, and you still have things to learn. St. Paul was a bold, driven leader who had to learn that God's strength shows up in weakness. You can learn it too.

SCRIPTURE

"God opposes the proud but gives grace to the humble."

— James 4:6

THIS WEEK I WILL

- Take correction once a day without defending myself.
- Say "thank you for telling me" or "you're right" at least once.
- Notice when I feel the need to be right or be in charge.

→ **In my own words, the big idea this week is...**

WEEK 4

Fault and Virtue

PRIDE needing to be right or in charge	ANGER AND RESENTMENT also scored high, so keep an eye on it
Opposite virtue: Humility. Seeing myself truthfully, and being okay when I'm not the one who's right or in charge.	**Opposite virtue: Patience and forgiveness.** Staying calm, and letting go of hurt instead of holding onto it.
Practice: once a day, take correction without defending myself.	**Practice:** take one slow breath before I respond, and pray for someone who hurt me, by name.
Prayer: "Lord, help me hear this."	**Prayer:** "Jesus, help me let this go."

→ **Where does Pride show up for me (school, sports, group projects, friends, family)?**

→ **What do I do or say when someone corrects me or disagrees with me?**

→ **How could I use my strengths to serve people instead of proving I'm right?**

→ **The humility practice I'll try this week, and when:**

WEEK 4

Daily Check-In

A few minutes a day. Short answers are perfect.

Each day, check what you did. Then write how it felt. Some days will be harder than others, and that's okay.

Day	Took correction	Paused first	How it felt / what I noticed
Mon	[ ]	[ ]	
Tue	[ ]	[ ]	
Wed	[ ]	[ ]	
Thu	[ ]	[ ]	
Fri	[ ]	[ ]	
Sat	[ ]	[ ]	
Sun	[ ]	[ ]	

WEEK 4

Reflect and Prepare

WEEKLY REFLECTION

→ **When did I feel the pull to be right or be in charge this week? What did I do?**

→ **How did it feel to take correction or let someone else lead?**

→ **Where could I ask God for help this week?**

FOR MY 1:1 WITH CASSANDRA

One thing I want to talk about:

A time my pride or anger showed up:

A practice I want to change or add:

WEEK 5 OF 6

Charisms and Your Mission

THE BIG IDEA

A **charism** is a gift from the Holy Spirit. It isn't just for you. It's given "for the common good." Your gifts are part of how God loves other people through you.

Yours are **Wisdom**, **Mercy**, and **Teaching**. You can see what's really going on in a situation, you care about people who are hurting, and you can help others understand. Notice how these gifts work together: they all help people. As a natural leader, you can use them to serve, not just to lead.

Gifts grow when you use them, so think of these as a starting point. Prophecy (speaking up for what's true) and Hospitality (making people feel welcome) scored the same as Teaching, so notice if either of those feels like you too. This week you'll try your gifts on purpose, in small ways.

SCRIPTURE

"To each is given the manifestation of the Spirit for the common good."

— 1 Corinthians 12:7

THIS WEEK I WILL

- Use each of my three gifts at least once.
- Notice what gives me energy and what drains me.
- Start writing my own mission sentence.

→ **In my own words, the big idea this week is...**

WEEK 5

Try Your Gifts

Wisdom - Seeing beneath the surface and knowing what to do.

Ideas: Listen to a friend's whole problem before you say anything. Ask a good question instead of giving an answer. Pray for wisdom before a big decision (James 1:5).

My plan this week:

Mercy - Caring for people who are hurting or left out.

Ideas: Sit with someone who's alone at lunch. Check on a friend who's struggling. Help someone without being asked, and without telling anyone.

My plan this week:

Teaching - Helping other people truly understand.

Ideas: Help a younger kid or sibling with something you know. Explain something about your faith to a friend. Teach someone a skill you're good at.

My plan this week:

Curious about Prophecy or Hospitality? They scored the same as Teaching. Try one small thing from each and see how it feels.

WEEK 5

My Mission Sentence

Fill in the blanks. It's okay if it changes. This is a first draft.

God made me _____ so that I can _____ for _____.

→ **Who is one person in my life I could use my gifts for this month?**

→ **What gives me energy when I use my gifts? What drains me?**

→ **What would it look like to use my gifts in my parish or youth group?**

WEEK 5

Daily Check-In

A few minutes a day. Short answers are perfect.

Each day, check if you used a gift on purpose. Then write what you did and how it felt.

Day	Gift I used (W, M, or T)	What I did	How it felt	Done
Mon				[ ]
Tue				[ ]
Wed				[ ]
Thu				[ ]
Fri				[ ]
Sat				[ ]
Sun				[ ]

WEEK 5

Reflect and Prepare

WEEKLY REFLECTION

→ **Which gift felt most natural? Which one stretched me?**

→ **Was there a moment this week when someone really needed what I had to give?**

→ **How does knowing my mission change how I see myself?**

FOR MY 1:1 WITH CASSANDRA

One thing I want to talk about:

A gift I want to grow:

A person I want to help:

WEEK 6 OF 6

Rooted in Today's World

THE BIG IDEA

You've learned a lot about yourself. Now the real question: how do you live this in the middle of your real life, with your phone buzzing, tests coming up, friendships changing, and a lot of voices telling you who to be?

Jesus said, *"I am the vine; you are the branches."* Being rooted means staying connected to Him while everything else moves fast. Your Pride may want you to win every argument, in the group chat, in class, and online. Your Controller may want you to run every group project and manage everything. Your Avoider may want you to scroll instead of facing something hard. You now have tools for each of those: Name It, Pray, Elect, and the Bridge Thought.

This week is about making a plan you'll actually use after the journal ends.

SCRIPTURE

“I am the vine; you are the branches.”

— John 15:5

THIS WEEK I WILL

- Notice how I feel before and after time on my phone.
- Use the protocol or a Bridge Thought at least once in the real world.
- Build my Rooted Plan.

→ **In my own words, the big idea this week is...**

WEEK 6

Looking at My Real Life

→ **What do I feel after I spend a long time on my phone or social media?**

→ **Where do I try to get my worth from (grades, being right, being in charge, friends)? What does God say about it?**

→ **Which friendships help me become who God made me to be? Which ones pull me away?**

→ **What is my Bridge Thought for when I feel like I have to win or be right, online or at school?**

WEEK 6

My Rooted Plan

→ **My daily anchor (3 small things I'll do every day):**

→ **My weekly rhythm (Mass, prayer, time with people who help me grow):**

→ **My go-to tools when I'm stressed (protocol, Bridge Thoughts, Scripture):**

→ **My trusted adults (people I can talk to when it's hard):**

→ **What I'll do when I slip (because I will, and that's okay):**

WEEK 6

Daily Check-In

A few minutes a day. Short answers are perfect.

Each day, check in on your real life. You're practicing for after the journal ends.

Day	Phone: how I felt after	A tool I used (protocol, bridge, prayer)	One good thing
Mon			[ ]
Tue			[ ]
Wed			[ ]
Thu			[ ]
Fri			[ ]
Sat			[ ]
Sun			[ ]

WEEK 6

Reflect and Prepare

WEEKLY REFLECTION

→ **What did I learn about myself in these six weeks?**

→ **What is one thing I'm proud of?**

→ **What do I want to keep doing?**

FOR MY 1:1 WITH CASSANDRA

One thing I want to talk about:

What I'll take with me:

What I still have questions about:

SIX WEEKS LATER

A Note to Future Me

Write a short letter to yourself. Tell yourself what you learned, what you want to remember, and what you hope for.

"Be still, and know that I am God."
Psalm 46:10

CUT OUT AND KEEP

My Two Cards

My Hard-Moment Protocol

1. Name it
What is happening inside me? Say it out loud.

2. Pray
One sentence, before I act.

3. Elect
The one next right thing.

My Bridge Thought

The unkind thought
I notice it.

The bridge
I cross it.

The kinder thought
Honest and kind.

Cut along the dotted lines. Keep one in your phone case, your school bag, or on your mirror.